

Morning Briefing

Tuesday, 7 July 2026 | Generated ~07:15 BST | London timezone

Data covers: US session Mon 6 Jul + European close Mon 6 Jul + Asian overnight Mon night into Tue morning

Samsung posted a record preliminary Q2 profit but its shares fell on profit-taking, clouding the Asian tech tone into the European open. NATO's Ankara Summit (day 1 of 2) is a live defense-sector catalyst today.

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Samsung Electronics posts record Q2 operating profit (89.4tn won, +19x YoY) but shares fall over 6%

CNBC / KoreaJoongAng Daily / TradingKey — 7 Jul 2026

Preliminary operating profit of ~\$58.4bn beat the 84.4tn won consensus on AI/HBM memory demand, but revenue missed forecasts and the stock sold off on profit-taking. Sets a cautious tone for Asian chip names and the broader AI-capex trade today.

NATO set to confirm Saab's GlobalEye over US planes at Ankara Summit, defying Trump pressure

Reuters / AeroTime / Global Defense Corp — 7 Jul 2026

Would be the largest order in the GlobalEye program's history, replacing NATO's ageing E-3A Sentry AWACS fleet. A European-vs-US defense-procurement flashpoint; Saab-sector relevant on day one of the two-day summit (7-8 Jul).

Tencent sells \$1.55bn stake in Kuaishou via block trade, cutting holding to 9.37%

Bloomberg / Reuters — 6 Jul 2026

Shares priced at a 3.2-6.2% discount to Monday's close; drops Tencent below the 10% "substantial shareholder" threshold. Kuaishou fell 9.6% Tuesday on the overhang even as the company ran a concurrent HK\$8.35bn buyback.

Microsoft cuts 4,800 jobs (~2% of workforce); Xbox absorbs the bulk in "most significant restructure" in its history

GeekWire / CNBC / TechCrunch — 6 Jul 2026

Roughly 1,600 of the cuts are in Xbox, with total gaming-division reductions expected near 3,200 (~20% of Xbox staff) this fiscal year; four studios (Ninja Theory, Undead Labs, Compulsion, Double Fine) are being divested or returned. AI-driven cost discipline continues at a mega-cap.

Rio Tinto-Glencore ~\$260bn merger talk resurfaces again as copper hits fresh record near \$13,700/t

CNBC / Investing News Network — ongoing, latest 3 Jul

Glencore +10% Friday on the revived talks. Caution: this saga has restarted and collapsed more than once already in 2026 (January restart, February collapse); treat any confirmation as unverified until an official joint statement.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES — PRE-OPEN

Source: Reuters/CNBC premarket wrap, Eurex. Data collected ~07:15 BST Tue 7 Jul. Absolute futures levels for today's pre-open session were not reliably sourced; directional read-through below combines Monday's strong European/US close against overnight Asian tech weakness.

Index	Last Futures Level	Expected Move (Tue)	Notes
Euro Stoxx 50	n/a	Cautious / mixed	No reliable pre-open print sourced; Samsung-led Asian tech weakness is a headwind after Monday's slight Euro Stoxx dip
Stoxx 600	n/a	Mixed	Index near 52-week highs; watch for follow-through on Monday's broad gains
DAX	n/a	Mixed	Fresh records this week; chip-linked names may lag on Samsung read-through
CAC 40	n/a	Little changed	Momentum from Monday's +0.51% session
FTSE 100	n/a	Constructive	Miners (Glencore, Rio Tinto) remain in focus on the merger-talk/copper story
S&P 500 E-Mini	n/a	Little changed	Holding near Monday's record Dow close (53,055.91)
Nasdaq 100	n/a	Mixed	US chip names (Intel) rebounding premarket even as Samsung sells off in Asia

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — MONDAY 6 JULY 2026

Source: ETF Trends World Markets Watchlist, CNBC, Trading Economics, ADVFN. Levels marked "~" are estimated from the prior confirmed close plus the sourced % change; treat as approximate.

Index	Level	Change	% Change	Session Note
Euro Stoxx 50	6,398	▼	-0.2%	Slight pullback after Friday's record; pan-European Stoxx 600 still up ~0.1% on the day
DAX	~25,880	▲	+0.39%	Extends the record run
CAC 40	n/a	▲	+0.51%	Strongest of the majors on the day
FTSE 100	~10,722	+43	+0.41%	Miners supportive on Rio Tinto/Glencore copper story

European bourses were broadly firmer Monday, led by the CAC 40, with the Euro Stoxx 50 the lone laggard on a modest pullback from Friday's record. Miners outperformed on the revived Rio Tinto-Glencore merger talk and record copper.

5. US MARKETS — MONDAY 6 JULY 2026 SESSION

Source: TheStreet, Yahoo Finance, CNBC. Data as of Monday's close.

Index	Close	Change (pts)	% Change	Notes
S&P 500	7,537.43	▲	+0.72%	Broad-based rally on revived AI optimism
Nasdaq Composite	26,121.16	▲	+1.12%	Tech-led; chip stocks shook off the late-June dip
Dow Jones	53,055.91	+155.84	+0.29%	First close above 53,000

Session tone: Broadly risk-on. Dow closed above 53,000 for the first time; Nasdaq and S&P rallied as pressure eased on the tech sector after last week's chip-stock wobble.

Leading names/sectors: Big Tech (Alphabet, Apple, Meta, Tesla) rallied; IBM +3%+ on a Bank of America price-target raise to \$330 from \$315; Foxconn's stronger-than-expected quarterly sales (reported Sunday) reinforced the AI-demand narrative.

Lagging: JetBlue downgraded by analysts on weak fundamentals; ZIM Integrated Shipping fell 6.8% on Israeli-government-related concerns.

Key takeaway: The AI trade found renewed footing after the late-June/early-July chip selloff, helped by Foxconn's sales beat. Note the same optimism did not carry through fully to Asia overnight, where Samsung's own record results triggered profit-taking rather than a rally.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — OVERNIGHT SESSION (TUE 7 JUL)

Source: BigGo Finance, JIJI Press, ETF Trends, CNBC, KED Global. Monday's confirmed closes shown; today's (Tuesday) intraday index-level moves were not reliably sourced as a clean set at ~07:15 BST collection time — stock-specific moves below are corroborated, but confirm index closes via Bloomberg/Reuters before trading.

Index	Level (Mon close)	Change	% Change	Session Note
Nikkei 225	69,737.69	▼	-0.01%	Effectively flat Monday; TOPIX hit a fresh record closing high the same session
Hang Seng	23,616.32	+266.29	+1.14%	Gained Monday; Tuesday overhang risk from the Tencent-Kuaishou block trade
Shanghai Composite	4,041.24	-2.41	-0.06%	Broadly flat
Kospi	~8,170	▲	+1%	Monday's close; Samsung and SK Hynix rebound continued ahead of earnings

Tone Tuesday: Samsung Electronics shares fell over 6% despite guiding to a record preliminary Q2 operating profit of 89.4tn won (+19x YoY, beating consensus), as investors took profits on an AI/HBM-memory-driven number that had been well flagged. SK Hynix trades with reference to the same theme ahead of its own results and a planned \$29bn Nasdaq depository-receipt listing. Kuaishou fell 9.6% on the Tencent stake-sale overhang. Confirm today's Kospi/Nikkei/Hang Seng closing levels before trading — a clean, consistent same-day print could not be sourced at collection time.

7. COMMODITIES

Source: Trading Economics, Investing.com, Kitco. Data collected ~07:15 BST Tue 7 Jul.

Commodity	Price	Change	% Change	Context
Brent Crude	\$72.16 /bbl	+\$0.24	~+0.3%	Little changed; Hormuz shipping flows continuing to normalise
WTI Crude	~\$68.7 /bbl	Flat	~flat	Trading below \$69, near its lowest since late February, as Hormuz flows recover and OPEC+ signals higher supply
Gold	~\$4,150-4,163 /oz	▼	Pulling back from Friday's ~\$4,189	Still near record territory after last week's rally on soft US jobs data
Natural Gas (Henry Hub)	\$3.255 /mmBtu	Flat	~flat	Little changed overnight
Copper (LME/futures)	~\$13,600-13,700 /t (~\$6.20-6.24/lb)	▲	Fresh all-time high	Driven by structural supply-shortfall forecasts and the Rio Tinto-Glencore merger story

Notable: Copper continues to set fresh records, above \$13,300/t and reported as high as ~\$13,700/t this week, on both the energy-transition demand story and the Rio Tinto-Glencore speculation. Gold is consolidating just off its highs after last week's jobs-data-driven spike; oil remains soft on improving Hormuz shipping flows and OPEC+ supply signals.

8. RATES & FX

Source: Trading Economics, Federal Reserve, Bundesbank. Data as of ~07:15 BST Tue 7 Jul. EUR/USD and GBP/USD current-session prints were not reliably sourced; last confirmed levels shown (mid/late-June) with staleness flagged.

Instrument	Level	Change	Notes
US 10Y Treasury Yield	~4.48%	+~2bp	Edged up from Thursday's 4.46% post-jobs-miss low
German 10Y Bund Yield	~2.92%	Steady	Holding just above 2.9%
EUR/USD	~1.143 (stale)	n/a	Last reliably sourced level; confirm intraday before use
GBP/USD	~1.34 (stale)	n/a	Last reliably sourced level; confirm intraday before use
DXY (Dollar Index)	100.85	-0.03%	Holding below 101, pressured since the June jobs miss

The dollar remains on the back foot below the 101 handle as markets keep discounting the odds of a September Fed hike after the soft June payrolls print. The US 10Y has ticked back up modestly from Thursday's low. The next FOMC decision is 28-29 July; minutes from the June 16-17 meeting (Warsh's first as Chair, rates held at 3.50-3.75%) are due Wednesday 8 July.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

Source: GlobalCapital headlines, FRED (ICE BofA spread series). Most subscriber-level deal terms were not accessible via search; levels marked n/a where unconfirmed.

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (MON 6 JUL)

EUR Corporate IG: No individual deal terms sourced for Monday specifically.

EUR HY: n/a

SSA / Sovereign: n/a

Financials: n/a

PIPELINE / EXPECTED TODAY & THIS WEEK (W/C 6 JUL)

Corporate IG: Couche-Tard and Louis Dreyfus are lining up seven-year euro trades, with Roquette adding to the hybrid queue, per GlobalCapital — a sign the corporate pipeline is swelling again post-holiday, though execution is described as dependent on a "shaky" backdrop.

Sterling IG: GlobalCapital reports the IG corporate market "eyeing a rebound in sterling issuance" this period.

SSA: Frontloading continues given elevated 2026 fiscal deficits (Germany, France); full-year gross EGB/SSA supply still projected near €1.4tn.

KEY SPREADS

Index	Level	Move	Direction
iTraxx Main (5Y)	n/a	n/a	No reliable intraday source
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	n/a	n/a	No reliable intraday source
CDX IG (5Y)	n/a	n/a	No reliable intraday source
Euro IG Corp Avg OAS	n/a	n/a	Described as near historically tight levels; 82.5% of IG bonds priced week of 2 Jul came inside/at issue spread (BVAL)

COMMENTARY

The euro primary market continues to reopen after last week's US holiday, with the corporate pipeline building (Couche-Tard, Louis Dreyfus, Roquette) and sterling issuance also expected to pick up. Investor demand remains strong: the week ending 2 July saw 45 new public bond offerings, with the large majority of IG deals pricing inside or at initial spread guidance per BVAL data, consistent with spreads being described as near historical tights.

The tone is constructive but not yet aggressive — issuers appear to be testing the window rather than flooding it. Financials and industrials remain the likeliest early movers this week; energy and transport issuers look more selective given ongoing oil-price and freight-rate volatility.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR

Source: Trading Economics, Kiplinger, Reuters/AeroTime. Times approximate; confirm exact release times before trading.

Time (BST)	Indicator	Consensus	Import.	Notes
All day	NATO Ankara Summit (day 1 of 2)	—	HIGH	Saab GlobalEye AWACS-replacement selection expected to be confirmed
Today	Vera Therapeutics FDA PDUFA decision (atacipept)	—	MED	Binary regulatory catalyst for IgA nephropathy treatment; shares +6% Monday into the decision
This week	Germany Industrial Production (May)	n/a	MED	April rose +0.4% MoM; exact release day this week not confirmed via search
Wed 8 Jul	FOMC June Meeting Minutes	—	HIGH	First meeting under Chair Warsh; market will parse tone after the soft June jobs report
Thu 9 Jul	PepsiCo Q2 earnings	Cons. EPS \$2.21	MED	Opens the consumer leg of US Q2 earnings season
Fri 10 Jul	Delta Air Lines Q2 earnings	Cons. EPS \$1.47	MED	Airline demand/fuel-cost read-through

Context: a lighter data week overall. The two live swing factors are the NATO Ankara Summit outcome and any Fed commentary reacting to Wednesday's June minutes.

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS

Source: CNBC, KuCoin, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger.

Company	Event	Date	Notes
Samsung Electronics	Q2 2026 preliminary guidance	7 Jul	Record 89.4tn won operating profit (+19x YoY); shares fell >6% on the print
Vera Therapeutics	FDA PDUFA decision (atacicept)	7 Jul	Accelerated-approval BLA for IgA nephropathy
SK Hynix	Nasdaq depositary-receipt listing (planned)	Ongoing	~\$29bn planned DR listing; stock volatile ahead of own Q2 results
PepsiCo	Q2 2026 earnings	9 Jul	Cons. EPS \$2.21 (+4.2% YoY), revenue ~\$24bn (+5.7% YoY)
Delta Air Lines	Q2 2026 earnings	10 Jul	Cons. EPS \$1.47 (-30% YoY), revenue ~\$18.9bn (+13.2% YoY)
JPMorgan Chase	Q2 2026 earnings	14 Jul	Cons. EPS ~\$5.44, +9.7% YoY; opens bank earnings
Netflix / Taiwan Semiconductor	Q2 2026 earnings	16 Jul	Key AI/streaming demand read-throughs

12. STOCKS TO WATCH — TUESDAY 7 JULY

Source: CNBC, Bloomberg, TradingKey, Reuters, Yahoo Finance.

Samsung Electronics (005930.KS) **Downside — sell the news**

Record preliminary Q2 operating profit (89.4tn won, +19x YoY, beat consensus) but shares fell >6% on profit-taking; revenue missed forecasts.

SK Hynix (000660.KS) **Watch — AI-memory read-through**

Trading off the Samsung print ahead of its own results; planned ~\$29bn Nasdaq depositary-receipt listing adds a separate catalyst.

Saab AB (SAAB-B.ST) **Upside — NATO order**

NATO expected to confirm GlobalEye as its AWACS replacement at the Ankara Summit — the largest order in the program's history.

Kuaishou Technology (1024.HK) **Downside — shareholder overhang**

Fell 9.6% Tuesday after Tencent sold a \$1.55bn block, even as Kuaishou ran a concurrent HK\$8.35bn buyback.

Vera Therapeutics (VERA) **Watch — binary FDA event**

FDA PDUFA decision today on atacicept for IgA nephropathy; shares +6% Monday into the readout.

Rio Tinto / Glencore (RIO / GLEN.L) **Watch — merger talk, treat cautiously**

Renewed \$260bn merger talk alongside record copper prices; this exact story has already restarted and collapsed once in 2026 — await an official statement before trading the headline.

ZIM Integrated Shipping (ZIM) **Downside risk**

Fell 6.8% Monday after Israeli government officials expressed concerns; shipping-sector relevant.

Microsoft (MSFT) **Watch — restructuring**

Cutting 4,800 jobs; Xbox undergoing its largest-ever restructure with four studios divested or returned to management.

Intel (INTC) **Upside — chip rebound**

+3% premarket Monday as US chip stocks rebounded from recent weakness; contrasts with Samsung's Asian-session sell-off.

IBM (IBM) **Watch — target raised**

+3%+ Monday after Bank of America raised its price target to \$330 from \$315.

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

US June jobs report: Nonfarm payrolls +57,000, well below the ~110,000 forecast. Fed funds futures imply roughly 50% odds of a September hike, down from ~67% pre-release.

Fed: Chair Kevin Warsh has not signalled a near-term move; next FOMC decision is 28-29 July, with June meeting minutes due Wednesday 8 July.

ECB: Raised its three key rates 25bp in June (deposit facility to 2.25%), the first hike of this cycle. Staff project headline inflation averaging 3.0% in 2026, easing to 2.3% in 2027.

Eurozone data: German industrial production (May) and Eurozone retail sales due this week; April industrial production had risen +0.4% MoM.

CORPORATE

Samsung Electronics: Record preliminary Q2 operating profit of 89.4tn won (+19x YoY) on AI/HBM memory demand; shares fell >6% on profit-taking despite the beat.

Microsoft: Cutting 4,800 jobs (~2% of workforce); Xbox's most significant restructuring in its 25-year history, with four studios divested.

Tencent / Kuaishou: Tencent sold a \$1.55bn block of Kuaishou shares, cutting its stake to 9.37% from 15.68%; Kuaishou fell 9.6% despite a concurrent buyback.

Rio Tinto / Glencore: Renewed ~\$260bn merger talk alongside record copper prices; the same talks have already restarted and collapsed once this year.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

NATO Ankara Summit (7-8 Jul): Alliance expected to confirm Saab's GlobalEye as its AWACS replacement, opting for a European platform over US alternatives despite reported pressure from President Trump for allies to buy American equipment.

Strait of Hormuz: Shipping traffic continuing to normalise post-ceasefire, helping cap oil prices near multi-month lows.

ZIM / Israel: Israeli government officials expressed concerns weighing on ZIM Integrated Shipping shares Monday; details of the specific concern were not corroborated via search and should be treated as preliminary.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5 (TUESDAY 7 JULY)

1. Samsung's Record Profit, Sold on the News

A 19-fold YoY operating-profit surge failed to lift the stock, which fell >6%. Tests whether the AI-memory rally has further room or is due a pause.

2. NATO Ankara Summit — Saab GlobalEye Decision

Expected confirmation of the largest order in the GlobalEye program's history, a live defense-sector and transatlantic-relations catalyst.

3. Tencent-Kuaishou Stake Sale Fallout

A \$1.55bn block trade knocked Kuaishou down 9.6% despite a concurrent buyback; watch for read-through to other Tencent-linked holdings.

4. Vera Therapeutics FDA Decision

A binary PDUFA readout on atacicept for IgA nephropathy; shares already up 6% into the event.

5. US Chip Rebound vs Asian Chip Wobble

Intel and IBM strength Monday contrasts with Samsung's Tuesday sell-off, an inconsistency worth watching for direction into the European open.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5 (W/C 6 JULY)

1. FOMC June Minutes (Wed 8 Jul)

First minutes under Chair Warsh; markets will parse how seriously the Fed weighed the soft June jobs data.

2. NATO Ankara Summit Conclusion (Wed 8 Jul)

Full outcomes and any contract-level detail on the Saab GlobalEye award due by the summit's close.

3. PepsiCo Opens Q2 Earnings Season (Thu 9 Jul)

First major US consumer-name read on demand and margins ahead of the bulk of Q2 reporting later in the month.

4. Delta Air Lines Earnings (Fri 10 Jul)

Airline demand and fuel-cost commentary, also relevant to the ZIM/shipping and broader transport read-through this week.

5. EUR Primary Market Pipeline Build

Couche-Tard, Louis Dreyfus and Roquette queuing euro trades; a fuller corporate calendar is likely to develop through the week.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5 (JULY 2026)

1. US Q2 Earnings Season — Banks From 14 Jul

JPMorgan opens bank earnings; Netflix and Taiwan Semiconductor (16 Jul) are the key AI-demand signals to watch after the Samsung profit-but-sell-off episode.

2. Fed Rate Path After the Jobs Miss

September hike odds near 50%; the 28-29 July FOMC meeting is the next hard decision point.

3. AI-Memory Supercycle vs Valuation Concerns

Samsung's record profit met with a sell-off crystallises the tension between strong fundamentals and stretched AI-capex valuations across the memory chain.

4. Rio Tinto-Glencore Mega-Merger

A ~\$260bn deal would be the largest in mining history; given the on-again-off-again pattern this year, only a formal announcement should move positioning materially.

5. NATO Defense Procurement Follow-Through

The Ankara Summit's GlobalEye decision and the broader Europe-vs-US procurement debate will shape defense-sector sentiment through the month.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY — TUESDAY 7 JUL

Samsung -6%+ despite record profit: does the AI-memory trade wobble spread to SK Hynix and US chip names at the open?

NATO Ankara Summit day 1: Saab GlobalEye confirmation watch

Kuaishou/Tencent overhang: any further block-trade or ownership-disclosure follow-through

Vera Therapeutics FDA PDUFA decision — binary event

Confirm today's Asian index closing levels independently — a clean same-day print was not available at collection time

1 WEEK — 6-12 JUL

FOMC June minutes (Wed) and NATO summit conclusion (Wed), both on the same day

PepsiCo (Thu) and Delta Air Lines (Fri) open US Q2 earnings season

EUR primary market pipeline building — Couche-Tard, Louis Dreyfus, Roquette

German industrial production (May) due this week, exact day unconfirmed

Rio Tinto/Glencore: watch for any official confirmation or denial

1 MONTH — JULY 2026

US Q2 earnings: banks from 14 Jul, then Netflix/TSMC (16 Jul) as key AI-demand signals

Fed rate path: next hard decision point is the 28-29 July FOMC meeting

AI-memory supercycle vs valuation risk, crystallised by Samsung's profit-but-sell-off

Rio Tinto-Glencore ~\$260bn merger: resolution one way or the other would be the month's biggest mining event

NATO defense procurement follow-through from the Ankara Summit

Sources used in this report:

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- Bloomberg — [bloomberg.com](https://www.bloomberg.com) (Tencent-Kuaishou, Kospi/Samsung coverage, FX/rates)
- Reuters / AeroTime / Global Defense Corp — NATO Ankara Summit, Saab GlobalEye
- TheStreet / Yahoo Finance — US index closes, sector detail
- ETF Trends World Markets Watchlist / BigGo Finance / JIJI Press — Asian index closes (Mon 6 Jul)
- KED Global / Korea Times / KuCoin / TradingKey / KoreaJoongAng Daily — Kospi, Samsung Q2 guidance
- Trading Economics — commodities, Bund/Treasury yields, DXY, industrial production
- Investing.com / Kitco — commodities pricing detail
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- FRED (St. Louis Fed) — ICE BofA credit spread series
- Federal Reserve — [federalreserve.gov](https://www.federalreserve.gov) (FOMC calendar, June statement)
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- Kiplinger / Earnings Whispers — earnings calendar

Data collected automatically ~06:45-07:15 BST, Tuesday 7 July 2026. Verify all figures before making any trading or investment decision. Figures marked n/a could not be reliably sourced. Today's same-day Asian index closing levels and current EUR/USD, GBP/USD prints could not be confirmed at collection time and should be checked via Bloomberg or Reuters Eikon before use.